

recon

User Manual

Version 0.61.0

2026-04-24

Repository · <https://github.com/thomas-starweb/recon>

License · MIT

About this manual

recon is a versatile network reconnaissance CLI written in Rust. It started as a curl clone and grew into a multi-protocol investigation tool covering HTTP(S), TLS certificate inspection, DNS, WHOIS, ping, traceroute, barcode encoding and decoding, file compression and archiving, markdown/HTML/PDF conversion, and a full Rhai script engine that exposes every protocol probe and helper for automation.

This manual covers every user-facing flag, every script binding, and shows how to combine them. The built-in `recon --help <topic>` command remains the quick reference; this document is the long-form companion.

A PDF rendering of this manual lives alongside it at [MANUAL.pdf](#). It is regenerated every time the markdown changes — see `CLAUDE.md` for the maintenance policy. Generate locally with:

```
recon --md-to-pdf docs/MANUAL.md \  
  --toc --toc-depth 3 --gfm --unsafe-html --page-break-on-h1 \  
  --doc-title 'recon User Manual' \  
  -o docs/MANUAL.pdf
```

Table of Contents

Contents

- About this manual
- Table of Contents
- Introduction
- Installation
 - From source
 - First-run bootstrap
- Quick start
- How recon is organized
- Global conventions
- Part II — CLI reference
 - HTTP / HTTPS requests
 - Core flags
 - Examples
 - Output control
 - Examples
 - Authentication & TLS
 - Examples
 - Client certificates (mTLS)
 - Examples
 - Proxy routing
 - Examples
 - Unix-domain sockets
 - Examples
 - HSTS persistent cache
 - Examples
 - IPFS / IPNS
 - Examples
 - Cookies
 - Examples
 - DNS
 - Examples
 - TLS certificate inspection
 - Examples
 - Ping, traceroute, netstatus

Examples

Email protection

Examples

SMTP

Examples

Mail retrieval (POP3, IMAP)

Examples

File transfer

Examples

Other protocols

SSH, SCP

Telnet

LDAP

WebSocket

RTSP

Dict (RFC 2229)

NTP, Memcached, Redis, MQTT

Source comparison

Examples

Document conversions

Examples

Cover pages

Page breaks

Barcode encoding & decoding

Examples

HRT (human-readable text under 1D barcodes)

Hashing

Examples

Compression & archiving

Examples

Encryption

Examples

Check digits

Examples

Sample data

Examples

JWT tokens

Examples

Text encoding

Examples

Serve mode

Examples

Write-out format

Examples

Browser automation

Examples

Meta flags

--flags — the quick lookup

Part III — Script engine

Running scripts

Bare-word invocation

Script language (Rhai)

CLI inheritance

Core helpers

Examples

Output bindings

Examples

File I/O bindings

Whole-file helpers

Streaming handle API

Examples

Comparison bindings

Examples

HTTP binding

Response map

Options map

Examples

Browser (sticky-session) binding

Examples

TCP, TCP-server, UDP

TCP client (existing)

TCP server (0.57.0)

UDP

Examples

Threading bindings

Examples

DNS binding

Examples

TLS probe binding

Examples

Ping binding

Examples

File transfer bindings

FTP

SFTP

TFTP

Gopher

Examples

Mail retrieval bindings

POP3

IMAP

Examples

SMTP binding

Examples

WebSocket binding

Examples

Other protocol bindings

LDAP

RTSP

Dict

NTP

Memcached

Redis

MQTT

Encoding & decoding bindings

Examples

Hashing binding

Examples

Compression & archive bindings

Compression

Archive

Examples

Encryption bindings

Examples

Check-digit binding

Examples

Sample-data binding

Examples

JWT binding

Examples

Email-protection binding

Examples
Netstatus binding
Text-encoding binding
Examples
Whois binding
IPFS binding
Agent-browser binding
Examples
SQLite binding
Examples
Document-conversion bindings
Opts map
Examples
Part IV — Appendices
Exit codes
Environment variables
Configuration file
Structure
~/.recon/ layout
Glossary

The table of contents above is auto-generated from H1/H2/H3 headings. Every entry is a clickable anchor in the PDF. For a narrative walkthrough of the structure, the four parts are:

- **Part I — Getting started:** introduction, installation, quick start.
 - **Part II — CLI reference:** every flag grouped by area, with examples.
 - **Part III — Script engine:** the Rhai interpreter, every binding, many examples.
 - **Part IV — Appendices:** exit codes, env vars, config, glossary.
-

Introduction

recon is a single-binary command-line tool. Its design goals, in rough order:

1. **Curl-compatible** where it overlaps with curl. Flag names, short forms, and behaviours match curl for HTTP(S) requests so existing tooling keeps working. `recon --help curl` lists the compatibility status.
 2. **Pure Rust** where possible. request + rustls for HTTP(S); hickory for DNS; comrak for markdown; flate2/brotli/zstd for compression; rxing for barcodes; tungstenite for WebSockets; rumqttn for MQTT. Where a pure-Rust path doesn't exist (headless-Chrome PDF rendering, for instance), recon shells out to a named external CLI (`agent-browser`) rather than linking the external dependency.
 3. **Protocol-rich**. HTTP(S), FTP(S), SFTP, TFTP, Gopher, SMTP(S), POP3(S), IMAP(S), SSH, SCP, Telnet, LDAP(S), WS(S), RTSP(S), Dict, NTP, Memcached, Redis, MQTT(S), IPFS/IPNS, Unix sockets, plus ping/traceroute.
 4. **Scriptable**. A Rhai script engine exposes every protocol probe, plus cryptography, compression, barcodes, JSON/YAML/XML handling, SQLite, file I/O, and multi-threaded concurrency. Scripts can stand in for shell pipelines and integration-test harnesses.
 5. **Diagnostic-friendly**. Verbose output, curl-style write-out, prettified JSON/XML, precise error messages, exit codes that match curl's.
-

Installation

From source

```
git clone https://github.com/thomas-starweb/recon
cd recon
cargo build --release
cp target/release/recon ~/.local/bin/      # or /usr/local/bin with sudo
```

You'll need:

- Rust 1.75 or newer (`rustup install stable`).
- A system linker; `cargo` handles the rest.
- For the optional `--html-to-pdf` / `--md-to-pdf` features: `agent-browser` on `$PATH` (`brew install agent-browser` on macOS, or `npm install -g agent-browser` elsewhere).

First-run bootstrap

```
recon --init
```

creates `~/.recon/` with `script/`, `jars/`, `sni/`, and a commented `config.toml` skeleton. Existing files are never overwritten. See the [~/.recon/ layout](#) appendix.

Quick start

```
# HTTP(S)
recon https://api.example.com/status
recon -X POST https://api.example.com/users -d '{"name":"a"}' -H 'Content-Type: application/json'
recon --json '{"q":"rust"}' https://api.example.com/search # auto-sets headers
recon -L https://short.url/foo # follow redirects
recon https://site.example.com --LHEAD # follow + HEAD

# Inspection
recon https://example.com --cert # inspect TLS
recon example.com --dns # A/AAAA/MX records
recon --ping 8.8.8.8 # TCP + ICMP
recon --traceroute 8.8.8.8
recon --whois example.com

# Email-protection
recon example.com --spf --dmarc --dkim selector1 --mta-sts --bimi --tls-rpt

# Barcodes
recon --encode qr -o out.png 'https://example.com'
recon --decode out.png # → qr<TAB>

# Conversions
recon --md-to-pdf README.md --toc --gfm -o README.pdf
recon --compare a.json b.json # GNU-diff

# Scripting
recon --script my-probe.rhai https://api.example.com
recon --init # bootstrap

# Help surface
recon --help # clap-generated
recon --flags # curl-style
recon --help http # deep-dive
recon --help script # deep-dive
recon --examples # curated examples
recon --version # protocols
```

How recon is organized

recon has one binary with many modes. The mode is selected by flag:

Mode group	Selector flags
HTTP request (default)	no mode flag, or a URL positional argument
Source-inspection	<code>--hash</code> , <code>--compress</code> , <code>--decompress</code> , <code>--encode</code> , <code>--decode</code> , <code>--encrypt</code> , <code>--decrypt</code>
Email-protection	<code>--spf</code> , <code>--dmarc</code> , <code>--dkim</code> , <code>--mta-sts</code> , <code>--bimi</code> , <code>--tls-rpt</code>
Network tests	<code>--ping</code> , <code>--traceroute</code> , <code>--netstatus</code> , <code>--whois</code>
Certificate inspection	<code>--cert</code> , <code>--dns</code> , or positional URL with <code>--cert</code> / <code>--dns</code>
SMTP send	<code>--mail-from</code> and <code>--mail-to</code>
Serve	<code>--serve</code> , <code>--serve-tls</code>
JWT	<code>--jwt-view</code> , <code>--jwt-sign</code> , <code>--jwt-validate</code>
Archive	<code>--archive</code> , <code>--extract</code>
Checkdigit	<code>--checkdigit</code> , <code>--checkdigit-create</code> , <code>--checkdigit-list</code>
Sample	<code>--sample</code> , <code>--sample-list</code>
Browser	<code>--browser-screenshot</code>
Compare	<code>--compare</code>
Docs	<code>--md-to-html</code> , <code>--md-to-pdf</code> , <code>--html-to-pdf</code>
Script	<code>--script</code> (turns recon into a Rhai interpreter)
Meta	<code>--init</code> , <code>--editor-cleanup</code> , <code>--list-charsets</code> , <code>--iconv</code>

Only the modes in the first group do an HTTP request. Every other mode is stand-alone.

Global conventions

- **-h, --help** prints the clap-generated flag summary. **--help <topic>** routes to a deep-dive help topic (see `recon --help` footer for the list).
 - **-V, --version** prints the curl-compatible multi-line banner. **--version-short** prints just the version number.
 - **-v** increases verbosity. Repeat (**-vv** , **-vvv**) for more detail. At default, connection lines and protocol handshakes are suppressed.
 - **-s, --silent** suppresses progress + verbose output. **--show-error** re-enables error output when **-s** is set.
 - **-o <FILE>** writes the response body to a file instead of stdout. **-O** / **--remote-name** derives the filename from the URL's path. **-J** / **--remote-header-name** respects Content-Disposition.
 - **-f, --fail** exits non-zero on HTTP 4xx/5xx (no body printed). **--fail-with-body** prints the body but still exits non-zero.
 - **-k, --insecure** disables TLS cert verification. Use for self-signed tests; never in production scripts.
 - **-p, --pretty** pretty-prints JSON / XML / YAML bodies. Auto-detection by Content-Type; can be disabled with **--no-pretty**.
 - **-L, --location** follows HTTP redirects. **--max-redirs N** caps the chain (default 10). **--LHEAD** follows and prints each hop's headers.
 - **-A "..."** sets the User-Agent. Default is `recon/<version>`.
 - **-e <URL>** sets the Referer header.
 - **-H 'Name: Value'** adds a request header. Repeat for multiple.
 - **--max-time <SECS>** overall operation timeout. **--connect-timeout <SECS>** TCP connect timeout (default 30).
 - **-w '<FORMAT>'** writes a curl-compatible write-out string to stdout after the body. See [Write-out format](#).
 - **--json <DATA>** curl's **--json** compatibility: sends DATA as a JSON body and auto-sets Content-Type: `application/json` + `Accept: application/json`.
 - **-T <FILE>** uploads the file as the request body (default method PUT).
 - **Environment variables** — many flags honor the same env var curl would (`HTTP_PROXY` , `HTTPS_PROXY` , `NO_PROXY` , `ALL_PROXY` , `SSL_CERT_FILE` , `CURL_CA_BUNDLE`). `recon`-specific ones are prefixed `RECON_`. See [Environment variables](#).
-

Part II — CLI reference

HTTP / HTTPS requests

The default mode. A positional URL (or `--url <URL>`) triggers an HTTP request through the request + rustls stack.

Core flags

Flag	Description
<code>-X, --request <METHOD></code>	GET, POST, PUT, PATCH, DELETE, HEAD. Default GET (PUT when <code>-T</code> set, POST when <code>-d</code> set).
<code>-H, --header <NAME: VALUE></code>	Add a request header. Repeatable.
<code>-d, --data <BODY @FILE></code>	Request body. <code>@file</code> reads from disk, <code>@-</code> reads stdin. Promotes GET → POST unless <code>-G</code> .
<code>--json <DATA></code>	Curl-compatible: sends DATA as JSON, sets <code>Content-Type: application/json</code> + <code>Accept</code> .
<code>--data-raw <DATA></code>	Like <code>-d</code> but <code>@file</code> is NOT processed (sends literal string).
<code>--data-binary <DATA></code>	Like <code>-d</code> but CR/LF are not stripped from <code>@file</code> content.
<code>--data-urlencode <DATA></code>	URL-encode DATA. Repeatable; values joined with <code>&</code> .
<code>-G, --get</code>	Send <code>-d</code> data as query parameters on GET (body empty).
<code>-T, --upload-file <PATH></code>	Upload file as request body. Default PUT.
<code>-L, --location</code>	Follow redirects (3xx).
<code>--max-redirs <N></code>	Cap redirect chain (default 10).
<code>--LHEAD</code>	Follow redirects and print each hop's headers.
<code>-e, --referer <URL></code>	Set Referer header. <code>--referrer</code> alias accepted.
<code>-A, --user-agent <STR></code>	User-Agent. Default <code>recon/<version></code> .
<code>--compressed</code>	Request + auto-decompress gzip/deflate/brotli/zstd.
<code>--max-time <SECS></code>	Total operation timeout (seconds, fractional OK).

Flag	Description
<code>--connect-timeout</code> <code><SECS></code>	TCP connect timeout (default 30).
<code>-f, --fail</code>	Exit non-zero on HTTP 4xx/5xx, suppress body.
<code>--fail-with-body</code>	Exit non-zero on 4xx/5xx but still print body.
<code>-4, --ipv4</code> / <code>-6, --ipv6</code>	Force IPv4 / IPv6 resolution.
<code>--resolve</code> <code><HOST:PORT:ADDR></code>	Override DNS for a specific host:port → addr. Repeatable.

Examples

```
# Simple requests
recon https://httpbin.org/get
recon -X POST https://api.example.com/v1/users -d '{"name":"a"}' -H 'Content-Type: application/json'
recon --json '{"query":"rust"}' https://api.example.com/search

# Body from files / stdin
recon https://upload.example.com -d @payload.json -H 'Content-Type: application/json'
cat body.json | recon -X POST https://api.example.com -d @-

# Upload
recon -T ./report.pdf https://upload.example.com/reports/ # PUT by default
recon -T ./report.pdf https://upload.example.com/ -X POST # override method

# Follow redirects
recon -L https://bitly.example.com/abc
recon --LHEAD https://example.com/ # show each header

# Fail fast
recon -f https://api.example.com/users/42 # exit 22 on failure
recon --fail-with-body https://api.example.com/users/42 # same but still print body

# Rate and timeout
recon --max-time 10 https://slow.example.com/
recon --connect-timeout 3 --max-time 8 https://flaky.example.com/
recon --limit-rate 500K https://download.example.com/big.bin -o big.bin
recon --speed-limit 10000 --speed-time 30 https://stalling.example.com/big.bin
```

Output control

Flag	Description
<code>-o, --output <FILE></code>	Write body to FILE (otherwise stdout).
<code>-O, --remote-name</code>	Filename = URL's last path segment (percent-decoded).
<code>-J, --remote-header-name</code>	Use Content-Disposition filename when saving.
<code>--create-dirs</code>	Create parent dirs for <code>-o</code> path.
<code>-i, --include</code>	Print response headers before body.
<code>-I, --head</code>	Print headers only; no body. Implies <code>-X HEAD</code> .
<code>-s, --silent</code>	Suppress progress + verbose output.
<code>--show-error</code>	Re-enable error output even when <code>-s</code> is set.
<code>-v, --verbose</code>	Verbose. Repeatable: <code>-v</code> , <code>-vv</code> , <code>-vvv</code> .
<code>-p, --pretty</code>	Pretty-print JSON / XML / YAML bodies.
<code>--no-pretty</code>	Disable auto-pretty (even when content-type suggests it).
<code>-w, --write-out <FORMAT></code>	Print a curl-compatible summary after the body. See Write-out format .
<code>--editor</code>	Open response body in <code>\$EDITOR</code> after the request.
<code>--json</code> (output-side inferred)	Combined with <code>-p</code> , forces JSON pretty-printing regardless of content-type.

Examples

```

# Save to file
recon https://example.com/favicon.ico -O favicon.ico # → favicon.ico
recon https://example.com/api/users.json -o users.json
recon https://x.example.com/deep/path/file.txt --create-dirs -o downloads/x/f

# Inspect headers
recon -I https://example.com/ # HEAD
recon -i https://api.example.com/v1/status # headers + body
recon -i -I https://example.com/ # forced HEAD

# Pretty-print
recon https://api.example.com/large.json -p
recon https://api.example.com/feed.xml -p # XML also supported
curl -s https://api.example.com/blob.yaml | recon -p - # stdin source

# Verbose progression
recon -v https://api.example.com/ # connection + TLS + headers
recon -vv https://api.example.com/ # plus intermediate request info
recon -vvv https://api.example.com/ # plus raw handshake + wire dump

# Writeout
recon https://api.example.com/ -w '\n%{http_code} in %{time_total}s (%{size_c

```

Authentication & TLS

Flag	Description
<code>-u, --user <USER:PASS></code>	HTTP Basic credentials.
<code>-k, --insecure</code>	Skip TLS cert verification.
<code>--tlsv1.2 / --tlsv1.3</code>	Force minimum TLS version.
<code>--cacert <PATH></code>	Trust an extra PEM root (on top of system roots).
<code>--interface <IP NAME></code>	Bind outgoing socket to a specific local IP or interface name (eth0, en0 on Linux/macOS via getifaddrs; Windows accepts IP literals only).
<code>--limit-rate <RATE></code>	Throttle download. Suffixes: K, M, G.
<code>--speed-limit <BYTES></code>	Minimum bytes-per-second (fails if rate drops).
<code>--speed-time <SECS></code>	Window for <code>--speed-limit</code> (default 30).

Examples

```
recon -u alice:s3cr3t https://private.example.com/
recon -k https://self-signed.example.com/
recon --tlsv1.3 https://example.com/           # refuse downgrade to 1.2
recon --cacert /etc/corp-root.pem https://internal.corp/
recon --interface 10.0.0.5 https://example.com/ # use a specific source IP
```

Client certificates (mTLS)

Shipped in 0.54.0. Present a client certificate during the TLS handshake for mutual TLS.

Flag	Description
<code>-E, --client-cert <PATH></code>	PEM-encoded client cert. May include the key inline.
<code>--client-key <PATH></code>	PEM key (when cert is cert-only).
<code>--cert-type <PEM DER></code>	Cert format. DER errors with a conversion recipe.
<code>--key-type <PEM DER ENG></code>	Key format. ENG refused (rustls has no engine concept).
<code>--pass <PASS></code>	Placeholder for encrypted PKCS#8 passphrase. Encrypted keys refused with an <code>openssl pkcs8</code> recipe.

Examples

```
# Combined cert+key PEM
recon -E ~/keys/bundle.pem https://mtls.example.com/

# Split cert and key
recon -E client.crt --client-key client.key https://mtls.example.com/

# Decrypt encrypted PKCS#8 externally first
openssl pkcs8 -in client.key.enc -out client.key
recon -E client.crt --client-key client.key https://mtls.example.com/
```

See also: `recon --help client-cert`.

Proxy routing

0.50.0 shipped the full proxy suite. Schemes auto-detected from the URL: `http://` , `https://` , `socks5://` , `socks5h://` .

Flag	Description
<code>-x, --proxy <URL></code>	Proxy URL. Falls back to <code>\$HTTPS_PROXY</code> / <code>\$HTTP_PROXY</code> / <code>\$ALL_PROXY</code> .
<code>-U, --proxy-user <USER:PASS></code>	Basic auth for the proxy.
<code>--noproxy <LIST></code>	Comma-separated bypass list (matches <code>\$NO_PROXY</code> semantics; <code>*</code> means bypass all).
<code>--proxy-insecure</code>	Skip cert verification on the TLS-to-proxy connection.
<code>--proxy-cacert <PATH></code>	Extra CA for the proxy connection.

Examples

```
recon -x http://proxy.corp:3128 https://api.example.com/
recon -x socks5h://127.0.0.1:9050 https://example.onion/
recon -x https://proxy.example.com:8443 -U alice:s3cr3t https://example.com/
HTTPS_PROXY=http://proxy.corp:3128 NO_PROXY='.internal' recon https://api.exa

# Script equivalent
recon --script - <<'EOF'
http("https://api.example.com/", #{
  proxy: "socks5h://127.0.0.1:9050",
  proxy_user: "alice:s3cr3t",
  noproxy: ".internal",
});
EOF
```

Unix-domain sockets

0.51.0. Route the HTTP request over a Unix socket instead of TCP. Host header and path are preserved; only the transport changes.

Flag	Description
<code>--unix-socket <PATH></code>	Socket path.

Examples

```
# Docker API
recon --unix-socket /var/run/docker.sock http://localhost/_ping
recon --unix-socket /var/run/docker.sock -p http://localhost/v1.40/version
recon --unix-socket /var/run/docker.sock http://localhost/v1.40/containers/js

# systemd-activated service
recon --unix-socket /run/app.sock http://localhost/api/v1/status
```

HSTS persistent cache

0.52.0. A curl-compatible HSTS cache that upgrades `http://` to `https://` before sending (when the host has a non-expired cache entry) and updates itself from `Strict-Transport-Security` response headers.

Flag	Description
<code>--hsts <FILE></code>	Load + update the HSTS cache at this path.

Examples

```
# Populate from an https:// response
recon --hsts ~/.recon/hsts.txt https://www.cloudflare.com/

# Future http:// requests to the same host are auto-upgraded
recon --hsts ~/.recon/hsts.txt http://www.cloudflare.com/
# * HSTS: upgrading http:// to https:// for www.cloudflare.com

# File format matches curl's --hsts:
cat ~/.recon/hsts.txt
# # HSTS cache (recon 0.58.1)
# # host expires_unix (leading . = includeSubDomains)
# .www.cloudflare.com 1808493843
```

IPFS / IPNS

0.49.0. `ipfs://<cid>` and `ipns://<name>` URLs are rewritten to an HTTP gateway URL before the request fires.

Flag	Description
<code>--ipfs-gateway <URL></code>	Gateway base URL. Default <code>https://ipfs.io</code> . Also read from <code>\$RECON_IPFS_GATEWAY</code> .

Examples

```
recon ipfs://QmYwAPJzv5CZsnA625s3Xf2nemtYgPpHdWEz79ojWnPbdG
recon --ipfs-gateway http://127.0.0.1:8080 ipfs://bafy... # local Kubo node
recon ipns://example.eth # via the default
```

Cookies

Flag	Description
<code>-b, --cookiejar <PATH></code>	SQLite cookie jar at PATH (created on demand).
<code>--cookies</code>	Read-only listing of the current cookie jar.
<code>--cookie-set <NAME=VAL></code>	Set a cookie in the jar.
<code>--cookie-delete <NAME></code>	Remove by name.

Cookies persist across invocations when you pass the same `--cookiejar` path. The `.db` format is SQLite; inspect with `sqlite3` or any sqlite viewer.

Examples

```
# Login, save cookies, browse with them
recon https://example.com/login -d 'user=alice&pass=secret' --cookiejar ~/jar
recon https://example.com/dashboard --cookiejar ~/jar.db -p

# Inspect
recon --cookiejar ~/jar.db --cookies

# Inject manually
recon --cookiejar ~/jar.db --cookie-set 'session=abc123; Domain=.example.com;
```

DNS

Flag	Description
<code>--dns</code>	Resolve A, AAAA, MX, TXT, NS, CNAME, SOA for the URL's host.
<code>--dns-type <LIST></code>	Comma-separated subset: A, AAAA, MX, TXT, NS, CNAME, SOA, PTR, CAA, DS, DNSKEY, HTTPS, SRV, SVCB.
<code>--dns-servers <LIST></code>	Comma-separated resolver IPs.

Flag	Description
<code>--dns-ipv4-addr <IP></code>	Bind DNS queries to a specific local IPv4.
<code>--dns-ipv6-addr <IP></code>	Same for IPv6.
<code>--dns-interface <NAME></code>	Accepted at the CLI; not yet plumbed (see OUT-OF-SCOPE.md). Use <code>--dns-ipv4-addr</code> / <code>--dns-ipv6-addr</code> as a workaround.

Examples

```
recon example.com --dns
recon example.com --dns-type A,AAAA,MX
recon example.com --dns --dns-servers 1.1.1.1,8.8.8.8
recon example.com --dns --dns-servers 127.0.0.1:5353 # local resolver
```

TLS certificate inspection

Standalone mode selected by `--cert` (without a `--cert <PATH>` value — it's the bool form of the flag).

Flag	Description
<code>--cert</code>	Inspect the server cert: subject, issuer, SANs, NotBefore/After, fingerprints.
<code>--cert-chain</code>	Walk the full intermediate chain.
<code>--sni <HOSTNAME></code>	Override the SNI value sent in the handshake.

Examples

```
recon https://example.com --cert
recon https://example.com --cert --cert-chain
recon https://example.com --cert --sni alt.example.com # request cert
```

Ping, traceroute, netstatus

Stand-alone modes.

Flag	Description
<code>--ping <HOST></code>	TCP ping by default, ICMP with <code>--icmp</code> .
<code>--icmp</code>	Force ICMP (needs raw sockets; root on Linux, CAP_NET_RAW elsewhere).
<code>--ping-count <N></code>	Packets (default 4).
<code>--traceroute <HOST></code>	Same as <code>--ping HOST --traceroute</code> .
<code>--max-hops <N></code>	Hop limit (default 30).
<code>--netstatus</code>	Run the probe bundle defined in <code>~/.recon/config.toml [netstatus]</code> .

Examples

```
recon --ping 8.8.8.8
recon --ping example.com --ping-count 10
recon --ping example.com:443 --icmp          # ICMP with explicit port hint
recon --traceroute 8.8.8.8 --max-hops 20
recon --netstatus                          # connectivity sweep
```

Email protection

A single URL can be probed for its whole email-auth stack in one invocation.

Flag	Description
<code>--spf</code>	SPF record validation (recursive include/redirect, lookup limit)
<code>--dmarc</code>	DMARC policy + record
<code>--dkim <SELECTOR></code>	DKIM for the given selector. Repeatable.
<code>--mta-sts</code>	MTA-STS policy
<code>--bimi [SELECTOR]</code>	BIMI record + optional VMC / SVG fetch
<code>--tls-rpt</code>	SMTP TLS-RPT record

Examples

```
# Full sweep
recon example.com --spf --dmarc --dkim selector1 --mta-sts --bimi --tls-rpt

# Single checks
recon example.com --spf
recon example.com --dkim selector1 --dkim selector2
recon example.com --bimi default          # explicit selector
```

SMTP

Stand-alone SMTP client. Send mail or just probe capabilities.

Flag	Description
<code>--mail-from <ADDR></code>	Envelope sender. Required for send.
<code>--mail-to <ADDR></code>	Envelope recipient. Repeatable.
<code>--mail-subject <STR></code>	Subject header. Default "recon SMTP test".
<code>--mail-body <STR></code>	Body. Accepts <code>@file</code> , <code>@-</code> .
<code>--mail-header <H: V></code>	Extra header. Repeatable.
<code>--smtp-auth <USER:PASS></code>	AUTH PLAIN → LOGIN chain.
<code>--smtp-helo <NAME></code>	HELO/EHLO name. Default <code>recon.local</code> .
<code>--no-starttls</code>	Don't negotiate STARTTLS.
<code>--dkim-key <PATH></code>	DKIM-sign outbound with this PEM key.
<code>--dkim-selector <SEL></code>	DKIM selector.
<code>--dkim-domain <DOM></code>	DKIM domain (defaults to <code>--mail-from</code> domain).

Examples

```
# Probe only
recon smtp://mail.example.com:25

# Send
recon smtp://smtp.example.com:587 --mail-from me@example.com --mail-to you@example.com
  --mail-subject 'Hi' --mail-body 'Test' --smtp-auth me:s3cr3t

# With DKIM signing
recon smtp://smtp.example.com:587 --mail-from me@example.com --mail-to you@example.com
  --dkim-key ~/.dkim/default.pem --dkim-selector default
```

Mail retrieval (POP3, IMAP)

Flag	Description
<code>--stls</code>	POP3: upgrade via STLS after CAPA.
<code>--imap-peek</code>	IMAP: use BODY.PEEK (don't flip \Seen).

URLs: `pop3://`, `pop3s://`, `imap://`, `imaps://`.

Examples

```
recon pop3s://alice:s3cr3t@pop.example.com/
recon pop3://alice:s3cr3t@pop.example.com/ --stls
recon imaps://alice:s3cr3t@imap.example.com/INBOX
recon imaps://alice:s3cr3t@imap.example.com/INBOX/3      # fetch message 3
recon imaps://alice:s3cr3t@imap.example.com/INBOX --imap-peek
```

File transfer

0.47.0 shipped FTP/FTPS, SFTP, TFTP, Gopher.

Protocol	URL scheme	Notes
FTP / FTPS	<code>ftp://</code> , <code>ftps://</code>	Anonymous by default; userinfo in URL or <code>-u</code> .
SFTP	<code>sftp://</code>	SSH-backed. <code>--privkey</code> for a specific key.
TFTP	<code>tftp://</code>	RFC 1350. <code>--tftp-blksize</code> for RFC 2348 block-size negotiation.
Gopher	<code>gopher://</code> , <code>gophers://</code>	Selector fetch.

Examples

```
# FTP – listing vs fetch
recon ftp://ftp.example.com/ # director
recon ftp://ftp.example.com/incoming/file.bin -o local.bin # retrieve
recon ftp://alice:s3cr3t@ftp.example.com/ # authenti

# SFTP
recon sftp://me@example.com/home/me/data.csv -o data.csv
recon sftp://me@example.com:2222/srv/ --privkey ~/.ssh/ci_rsa

# TFTP
recon tftp://tftp.example.com/pxelinux.cfg/default
recon tftp://tftp.example.com/boot.img -o boot.img --tftp-blksize 8192

# Gopher
recon gopher://gopher.floodgap.com/
recon gopher://gopher.floodgap.com/0/gopher/proxy
```

Other protocols

SSH, SCP

```
recon ssh://me@example.com -- uname -a # SSH exec; prints stdout
recon scp://me@example.com/etc/motd -o motd # SCP fetch
```

Telnet

```
recon telnet://router.example.com:23
```

LDAP

```
recon ldap://ldap.example.com -H 'Bind: cn=admin,dc=example,dc=com'
recon ldaps://ldap.example.com # implicit-TLS
```

WebSocket

```
recon wss://echo.websocket.events # handshake + Ping/Pong
```

RTSP

```
recon rtsp://camera.example.com/stream1 # OPTIONS
```

Dict (RFC 2229)

```
recon dict://dict.org/d:recon
```

NTP, Memcached, Redis, MQTT

```
recon ntp://pool.ntp.org # clock offset + rtt
recon memcache://cache.example.com/?stats # text-protocol stats
recon redis://cache.example.com/ # PING
recon redis://cache.example.com/ -X INFO # arbitrary RESP command
recon mqtt://broker.example.com --mqtt-topic status --mqtt-message 'hello'
recon mqtts://broker.example.com --mqtt-user alice --mqtt-pass s3cr3t ...
```

Source comparison

0.53.0 shipped `--compare` . Diff two sources (URL / path / `-` stdin). HTTP(S) sources flow through the full request pipeline so every request flag (`-H`, `-u`, `-L`, `-k`, cookies, proxy, HSTS) applies.

Flag	Description
<code>--compare <A> </code>	Two sources.
<code>--compare-format <FMT></code>	<code>unified</code> (default), <code>summary</code> , <code>sxs</code> .
<code>--compare-context <N></code>	Unified context lines (default 3).

Exit codes follow GNU `diff` : 0 identical, 1 differ, 2+ source-load error.

Examples

```
recon --compare one.json two.json
recon --compare https://api.example.com/v1/status ./baseline.json
curl -s https://a/ | recon --compare - ./baseline.json
recon --compare a.txt b.txt --compare-format summary
recon --compare a.txt b.txt --compare-format sxs
recon --compare a.json b.json --compare-context 5
```

Document conversions

0.58.0 shipped `markdown` / `HTML` / `PDF`. See also `--help docs` .

Flag	Description
<code>--md-to-html <SRC></code>	Markdown → HTML via comrak. Output <code>-o PATH</code> or stdout.
<code>--md-to-pdf <SRC></code>	Markdown → PDF (via agent-browser). <code>-o PATH</code> required.
<code>--html-to-pdf <SRC></code>	HTML → PDF (via agent-browser).
<code>--toc</code>	Inject a linkable TOC.
<code>--toc-depth <N></code>	Include headings up to H <code>N</code> (default 3).
<code>--toc-title <STR></code>	TOC heading (default "Contents").
<code>--doc-title <STR></code>	<code><title></code> + PDF metadata title.
<code>--doc-css <PATH></code>	Inline a custom stylesheet.
<code>--no-default-css</code>	Skip bundled default CSS.
<code>--gfm</code>	Enable GitHub-flavored extensions (tables, task lists, strikethrough, autolinks, footnotes, tagfilter).
<code>--unsafe-html</code>	Allow raw HTML passthrough (comrak's <code>unsafe_</code> flag). Needed for cover pages and explicit <code><div class="page-break"></code> markers. Off by default; assume the markdown is trusted when on.
<code>--page-break-on-h1</code>	Start a new PDF page before every top-level <code>#</code> heading except the first. No visible effect in HTML output (Chrome's printToPDF honours the <code>break-before: page</code> rule).

Examples

```
recon --md-to-html README.md --toc --gfm -o README.html
recon --md-to-pdf CHANGELOG.md --toc --gfm --doc-title 'recon release notes'
recon --html-to-pdf report.html -o report.pdf
curl -s https://example.com/doc.md | recon --md-to-html - --toc -o doc.html
recon --md-to-pdf notes.md --toc --doc-css print.css -o notes.pdf
recon --md-to-pdf notes.md --no-default-css --doc-css corp.css -o notes.pdf

# Book-style: cover page + chapter breaks
recon --md-to-pdf book.md --toc --gfm --unsafe-html --page-break-on-h1 \
    --doc-title 'My Book' -o book.pdf
```

Cover pages

With `--unsafe-html`, raw HTML passes through the markdown parser verbatim. The bundled CSS styles `<div class="cover">` as a full-page centered block with an automatic page break after:

```
<div class="cover">

# My Document

<div class="subtitle">An illustrated guide</div>

<hr>

<div class="version">Version 1.0</div>
<div class="date">2026-04-24</div>
<div class="author">Alice Example</div>

</div>

# First chapter

Body text...
```

The cover block uses a `min-height: 90vh` flex container with centered content. `.subtitle`, `.version`, `.date`, `.author`, and `.meta` child classes pick up smaller, muted styling. A horizontal rule becomes a narrow divider.

Page breaks

Two routes:

1. **`--page-break-on-h1`** — every top-level `#` heading starts a new PDF page (except the first, which opens the document). No markdown changes required.
2. **Explicit markers (needs `--unsafe-html`)** — embed one of:

```
<div class="page-break"></div>
<hr class="page-break">
```

anywhere in the markdown. The CSS `break-after: page` kicks in.

Chrome's printToPDF is the renderer for both `--md-to-pdf` and `--html-to-pdf`, so any CSS that speaks `break-before`, `break-after`, or `page-break-*` works. `@page` rules for size and margins (defined in the bundled default CSS) are honored too — override via `--doc-css` or inline `<style>` with `--unsafe-html`.

Barcode encoding & decoding

Flag	Description
<code>--encode</code> <code><FORMAT></code>	qr, datamatrix, code128, code39, ean13, upca, aztec, pdf417.
<code>--encode-format</code> <code><FMT></code>	ascii (default), svg, png. Inferred from <code>-o</code> extension.
<code>--from-file</code> <code><PATH></code>	Encode input from file (mutually exclusive with positional).
<code>--encode-list</code>	List all supported formats.
<code>--qr-level</code> <code><L M Q H></code>	QR error-correction level (default M).
<code>--hrt / --no-hrt</code>	Human-readable text under 1D barcodes. Default on for EAN/UPC, off for Code128/39. SVG + ASCII only (PNG HRT deferred).
<code>--decode</code> <code><IMAGE></code>	Scan a PNG/JPEG/WebP for any supported format. <code>-</code> for stdin.
<code>--decode-hints</code> <code><LIST></code>	Comma-separated format restriction.
<code>--decode-all</code> <code><IMAGE></code>	Scan for every barcode in the image; one line per detection.

Examples

```
# Encode
recon --encode qr -o qr.png 'https://example.com'
recon --encode qr --qr-level H -o durable.png 'sticker text'
recon --encode pdf417 -o id.png 'stacked linear code'
recon --encode aztec -o ticket.png 'transit ticket'
recon --encode ean13 --encode-format svg '4006381333931' > product.svg
recon --encode qr --from-file msg.txt -o qr-of-file.png

# Decode
recon --decode ticket.png # → aztec<TAB>transit tic
cat code.png | recon --decode -
recon --decode mystery.png --decode-hints qr,datrix
recon --decode bottle.jpg --decode-hints ean13
recon --decode-all sheet.png # every code in the image
```

HRT (human-readable text under 1D barcodes)

EAN-13 and UPC-A get HRT by default; Code128 and Code39 don't unless you pass `--hrt` . Implemented for ASCII and SVG output. PNG output ignores the flag — PNG HRT is deferred pending bundled-font work.

```
recon --encode ean13 --encode-format svg '4006381333931' -o retail.svg
recon --encode code128 --hrt --encode-format svg 'SHIP-4711' -o box.svg
recon --encode ean13 --no-hrt '4006381333931' -o bare.svg
```

Hashing

Flag	Description
<code>--hash</code> <code><ALGO></code>	md5, sha1, sha224, sha256, sha384, sha512, sha3_256, sha3_512, blake3.
<code>--hash-list</code>	List supported algorithms.

Examples

```
recon --hash sha256 /etc/hosts
recon --hash sha256 https://example.com/file.iso           # hash a URL
cat payload.bin | recon --hash blake3 -
echo -n "hello" | recon --hash md5 -
```

Compression & archiving

Flag	Description
<code>--compress <ALGO></code>	gzip, deflate, brotli, zstd, bzip2, lz4, xz, snap.
<code>--decompress <ALGO></code>	Same set; auto-detect via magic bytes if ALGO is <code>auto</code> .
<code>--compress-list</code>	List supported algorithms.
<code>--compression-level</code> <code><N></code>	1..22 (depends on algo).
<code>--archive <DEST></code>	Create zip/tar/tar.gz/tar.xz/tar.bz2. Positional args after DEST are sources.
<code>--extract <SRC></code>	Extract an archive. <code>-o DIR</code> to choose destination.

Examples

```

recon --compress gzip /etc/hosts -o hosts.gz
recon --decompress auto hosts.gz -o hosts.plain
recon --compress zstd --compression-level 19 big.bin -o big.zst

recon --archive backup.tar.gz ~/Documents ~/src
recon --extract backup.tar.gz -o restore/
recon --extract release.zip

```

Encryption

age-based + PGP shell-out.

Flag	Description
<code>--encrypt</code>	Encrypt stdin / file to age format. Requires <code>--recipient</code> or <code>--pgp-recipient</code> .
<code>--decrypt</code>	Decrypt age / PGP. Needs <code>--identity</code> or a configured GPG keyring.
<code>--encrypt-keygen</code>	Generate a new age keypair.
<code>--recipient <KEY></code>	Age recipient (X25519 or ssh-ed25519). Repeatable.
<code>--identity <PATH></code>	Age identity file for decryption.
<code>--passphrase</code>	Use passphrase-based (scrypt) encryption. Mutually exclusive with <code>--recipient</code> .
<code>--armor</code>	Armored (base64 PEM) output.
<code>--pgp-recipient <EMAIL FPR></code>	PGP recipient (shells out to <code>gpg</code>).

Examples

```

# Generate
recon --encrypt-keygen > age.key          # public key printed to stderr

# Encrypt
recon --encrypt --recipient age1abc... README.md -o README.md.age
recon --encrypt --passphrase secret.txt -o secret.txt.age --armor

# Decrypt
recon --decrypt --identity age.key README.md.age -o README.md

# PGP
recon --encrypt --pgp-recipient alice@example.com msg.txt -o msg.txt.pgp

```

Check digits

Flag	Description
<code>--checkdigit <ALGO></code>	Verify an input.
<code>--checkdigit-create <ALGO></code>	Compute and append the check digit.
<code>--checkdigit-list</code>	List supported algorithms (70+).

Notable algorithms shipped in 0.61.0:

- **Latin-American + Australian + Mexican tax IDs:** `br_cpf`, `br_cnpj`, `ar_cuit`, `ar_cuil`, `cl_rut`, `pe_ruc`, `au_abn`, `mx_rfc`. All except ABN support `--checkdigit-create`; ABN's mod-89 algorithm has no single-digit inverse.
- **110+ year warnings** on Nordic + Bulgarian personal IDs: `cpr` (Denmark), `henkilotunnus` (Finland), `fodselsnummer` (Norway), `bg-egn` (Bulgaria). Same idiom as the Swedish `personnummer`: when the parsed birth year implies age ≥ 110 , the verdict's `comment` flags a likely data-entry error.

Examples

```
recon --checkdigit isbn13 '9780131103627'      # → valid
recon --checkdigit-create isbn13 '978013110362'  # → 9780131103627
recon --checkdigit-create ean13 '400638133393'  # → 4006381333931
recon --checkdigit personnummer '19900101-1239' # Swedish personal ID
recon --checkdigit-list | head -20
```

Sample data

Flag	Description
<code>--sample <NAME></code>	Emit a sample payload (faker-style).
<code>--sample-list</code>	List all named samples.

Examples

```
recon --sample-list
recon --sample json-user
recon --sample json-user -o user.json
recon --sample css                # minimal CSS boilerplate
```

JWT tokens

Flag	Description
<code>--jwt-view <TOKEN></code>	Decode + pretty-print. No signature check.
<code>--jwt-sign <PAYLOAD></code>	Sign a JWT. Pair with <code>--jwt-secret</code> or <code>--jwt-key</code> .
<code>--jwt-validate <TOKEN></code>	Validate signature + standard claims.
<code>--jwt-secret <STR></code>	HMAC secret (HS256/384/512).
<code>--jwt-key <PATH></code>	RSA/ECDSA/Ed25519 PEM key.
<code>--jwt-alg <ALG></code>	HS256, HS384, HS512, RS256, RS384, RS512, ES256, ES384, EdDSA.

Examples

```
recon --jwt-view "$(cat token.txt)"
recon --jwt-sign '{"sub":"alice","exp":999999999}' --jwt-secret sharedkey --
recon --jwt-validate "$TOKEN" --jwt-secret sharedkey
recon --jwt-sign '{"sub":"alice"}' --jwt-key private.pem --jwt-alg RS256
```

Text encoding

Flag	Description
<code>--iconv <SRC:DST></code>	Standalone <code>iconv</code> replacement.
<code>--list-charsets</code>	List supported charset labels.

Examples

```
recon --iconv utf-8:iso-8859-1 greek.txt -o greek-latin1.txt
echo 'Hello' | recon --iconv utf-8:utf-16le - -o hello.utf16
recon --list-charsets | head -20
```

Serve mode

Flag	Description
<code>--serve [ADDR]</code>	Start an HTTP server serving the cwd (default <code>127.0.0.1:8000</code>).
<code>--serve-tls [ADDR]</code>	HTTPS. Requires <code>--serve-cert</code> + <code>--serve-key</code> .

Flag	Description
<code>--serve-cert <PATH></code>	Server cert (PEM).
<code>--serve-key <PATH></code>	Server key (PEM).
<code>--serve-sni</code> <code><HOST:CERT:KEY></code>	Per-hostname SNI mapping. Repeatable.

Examples

```
recon --serve
recon --serve 0.0.0.0:3000
recon --serve-tls 0.0.0.0:8443 --serve-cert cert.pem --serve-key key.pem
recon --serve-tls :443 --serve-sni a.example.com:a.pem:a.key --serve-sni b.ex
```

Write-out format

The `-w '<FORMAT>'` flag prints a curl-compatible summary after the response. Variable names match curl's.

Variable	Description
<code>%{http_code}</code>	HTTP status code
<code>%{size_download}</code>	Body size in bytes
<code>%{size_header}</code>	Response header bytes
<code>%{size_request}</code>	Request bytes sent
<code>%{size_upload}</code>	Uploaded bytes
<code>%{speed_download}</code>	Bytes-per-second
<code>%{time_total}</code>	Total operation time (seconds, fractional)
<code>%{time_starttransfer}</code>	TTFB
<code>%{time_redirect}</code>	Time spent on redirects
<code>%{url}</code>	Final URL (after redirects)
<code>%{url_effective}</code>	Same as <code>%{url}</code>
<code>%{content_type}</code>	Response Content-Type
<code>%{num_redirects}</code>	Redirect count
<code>%{remote_ip}</code>	Final peer IP
<code>%{remote_port}</code>	Peer port

Variable	Description
<code>%{local_ip} / %{local_port}</code>	Local side
<code>%{scheme}</code>	http or https

Not yet accurate: `time_namelookup`, `time_connect`, `time_appconnect`, `time_pretransfer` render as `0.000000` — see OUT-OF-SCOPE.md.

Examples

```
recon https://example.com/ -w '\n%{http_code} %{time_total}s %{size_download}
recon -I https://example.com/ -w '%{scheme}://%{remote_ip}:%{remote_port} %{f
recon -L https://short.url/x -w '%{num_redirects} hops → %{url_effective}\n'
```

Browser automation

Flag	Description
<code>--browser-screenshot <URL></code>	Open in agent-browser, save a PNG to <code>-o PATH</code> .

Requires `agent-browser` on `$PATH`. See [Script engine → agent-browser](#) for deeper automation.

Examples

```
recon --browser-screenshot https://example.com -o example.png
```

Meta flags

Flag	Description
<code>--flags</code>	Alphabetical curl-style flag listing (<code>--help all</code> equivalent).
<code>--examples</code>	Curated examples, paged.
<code>--init</code>	Bootstrap <code>~/recon/</code> (script/, jars/, sni/, config.toml).
<code>--editor</code>	Open response in <code>\$EDITOR</code> .
<code>--editor-cleanup</code>	Remove leftover <code>~/recon/editor-*</code> tempfiles.
<code>--no-pager</code>	Disable paging of <code>--help</code> / <code>--examples</code> / <code>--flags</code> .

`--flags` — the quick lookup

`recon --flags` prints every flag alphabetically sorted by long name, curl's `--help all` layout:

```
(short or 4-space pad) --long <VALUE>  short description
```

Short description is capped at ~52 characters (first sentence of each flag's internal help text). Use this as the quick index when you know roughly what you want but not the flag name; follow up with `recon --help <topic>` for the long-form deep-dive.

Example:

```
$ recon --flags | head
  --age                Force the age backend, even if...
  --archive <DEST>     Create an archive
  --armor              Produce ASCII-armored output...
  --bimi <SELECTOR>    Validate the BIMI record
  --browser-screenshot <URL> Open URL in a browser and save...
  --cacert <PATH>       Path to a PEM-encoded CA certificate...
  --cert               Fetch and display the server's TLS cert
  --cert-type <PEM|DER> Format of --client-cert
-E, --client-cert <PATH> Client certificate for mTLS
  --client-key <PATH>  Private key for the client certificate
```

The listing is auto-paged through `$PAGER`. Pipe to `grep` for search:

```
recon --flags | grep -i cookie
recon --flags | grep -E '^\s*-[a-zA-Z],' # only flags with short keys
```

Part III — Script engine

recon ships an embedded [Rhai](#) interpreter. Every protocol probe, every cryptography primitive, every helper is exposed to scripts. Scripts run via `--script PATH`; `return N` from the top level becomes the process exit code.

Running scripts

```
recon --script ./probe.rhai          # run an absolute / relative
recon --script probe                 # falls back to ~/.recon/scr
recon --script probe https://example.com alice # positional args → args[1],
```

Script lookup order:

1. Exact path (with or without `.rhai` extension).
2. `~/.recon/script/<name>.rhai`.
3. If neither exists — error.

The shipped example scripts in `script/*.rhai` are copy-friendly starting points:

```
cp script/*.rhai ~/.recon/script/
recon --script http example.com
```

Bare-word invocation

After `recon --init` + copying scripts to `~/.recon/script/`, scripts become first-class by name:

```
recon --script tcp-echo 127.0.0.1:9000
recon --script doc-convert README.md output.pdf
recon --script client-cert ~/keys/bundle.pem https://mtls.example.com/
```

Script language (Rhai)

Rhai is a lightweight embedded script language. Key facts for newcomers:

- **Let bindings:** `let x = 42;` (mutable by default; use `const` for compile-time constants).

- **Types:** integers (i64), floats (f64), bools, strings, arrays, maps (object literals: `#{ key: value }`), Blob (Vec).
- **String interpolation:** ``Hello ${name}``.
- **Closures / function pointers:** `|a, b| { a + b }`.
- **For loops:** `for i in 0..5 { ... }` (integer ranges), `for item in array { ... }`, `for (k, v) in map { ... }`.
- **Functions:** `fn f(a) { a * 2 }`.
- **Imports:** `import "module-name" as m;` — resolved against the script's directory and `~/.recon/script/`.
- **Error handling:** `try { ... } catch(e) { ... }`.
- **Reserved words** that might surprise: `spawn` (use `thread_spawn`), `async`, `await`, `throw` (all reserved even when unused).

Useful idioms:

```
// Map with computed keys
let cfg = #{
  user: env("USER"),
  host: "api.example.com",
  timeout_ms: 5000,
};

// Chainable array methods
let evens = (0..20).filter(|n| n % 2 == 0).map(|n| n * 10);

// Early return
if !file_exists("/etc/passwd") { return 1; }
```

CLI inheritance

When a script runs, two read-only constants land at the top of its scope:

- **args** — an array of strings. `args[0]` is the script path; `args[1..]` are the positional arguments after `--script PATH`.
- **flags** — a map mirroring the relevant CLI flags (lower-case, snake_case keys). Useful for scripts that want to respect `-v`, `-k`, `--connect-timeout`, etc. at invocation time.

```
// Reasonable defaults, overridable via args
let url = if args.len() > 1 { args[1] } else { "https://example.com/" };
let timeout = flags.connect_timeout; // from -C / --connect-timeout

let r = http(url, #{ timeout_ms: timeout * 1000 });
print(`${r.status} ${r.url}`);
```

Bindings that take their own opts map (e.g. `http(url, opts)`) layer the caller's opts ON TOP of the CLI defaults. If the caller wants to ignore the CLI's `-H` header list, they can pass `headers: []` in their opts.

Core helpers

Exposed by `src/script/bindings/helpers.rs`. Always available.

Function	Returns	Description
<code>sleep_ms(ms)</code>	—	Block the current thread.
<code>sleep(ms)</code>	—	Alias of <code>sleep_ms</code> (added in 0.56.0 for thread-side readability).
<code>env(name)</code>	string	Process environment variable; <code>""</code> if unset.
<code>env(name, default)</code>	string	With fallback.
<code>now()</code>	int	Unix seconds.
<code>now_ms()</code>	int	Unix milliseconds.
<code>assert(cond, msg)</code>	—	Throws on false.
<code>json_parse(s)</code>	Dynamic	Parse JSON text → native Rhai value.
<code>json_stringify(v)</code>	string	Serialize to compact JSON.
<code>json_stringify(v, pretty)</code>	string	<code>pretty: true</code> = 2-space indent.
<code>json_stringify(v, n)</code>	string	<code>n</code> = spaces per indent (clamped 1..=8).

Rhai's built-in `print(x)` writes `x` + newline via the engine's debug callback. `recon` adds byte-precise siblings (see next section).

Examples

```
// Probe a URL, fail fast
let r = http("https://api.example.com/health");
assert(r.status == 200, `expected 200, got ${r.status}`);

// JSON round-trip
let obj = json_parse(r.body);
print(json_stringify(obj, true));    // pretty

// Time gate
let t0 = now_ms();
let r = http("https://slow.example.com/");
let dt = now_ms() - t0;
print(`took ${dt} ms`);

// Polling with timeout
let deadline = now() + 30;
while now() < deadline {
    let r = http("https://example.com/ready");
    if r.status == 200 { return 0; }
    sleep_ms(500);
}
return 1;
```

Output bindings

0.53.0. Byte-precise output that Rhai's built-in `print()` can't do.

Function	Description
<code>print_raw(s)</code> / <code>print_raw(blob)</code>	Write to stdout without a trailing newline; flush.
<code>eprint(s)</code>	Write to stderr with a newline.
<code>eprint_raw(s)</code> / <code>eprint_raw(blob)</code>	Write to stderr without newline; flush.
<code>flush()</code>	Explicit stdout flush.

Examples

```
// Progress indicator
print_raw("loading");
for i in 0..10 {
    sleep_ms(200);
    print_raw(".");
}
print_raw("\n");

// Send bytes to stdout (e.g. for piping into another tool)
let bytes = http("https://example.com/image.png").body;
print_raw(bytes);

// Log to stderr; keep stdout for data
eprint(`[${now_ms()}] starting probe...`);
print_raw(json_stringify(result));    // stdout stays parseable
```

File I/O bindings

0.53.0. Both whole-file convenience and a streaming handle API.

Whole-file helpers

Function	Description
<code>file_read(path)</code>	Read entire file → Blob.
<code>file_write_all(path, blob str)</code>	Overwrite. Returns bytes written.
<code>file_append_all(path, blob str)</code>	Append; creates if absent.
<code>file_exists(path)</code>	Bool.
<code>file_size(path)</code>	Bytes.
<code>file_delete(path)</code>	Unlink.

`path` accepts a filesystem path or a `file://` URL.

Streaming handle API

Function	Description
<code>file_open(path, mode)</code>	Returns a <code>FileHandle</code> . Modes: <code>r</code> , <code>w</code> (truncate+create), <code>rw</code> , <code>rw+</code> / <code>w+</code> (read+write+create+truncate), <code>a</code> (append+create), <code>ra</code> (append+read).
<code>file_read(h, n)</code>	Read up to <code>n</code> bytes → Blob.
<code>file_read_all(h)</code>	Drain to Blob.

Function	Description
<code>file_write(h, blob str)</code>	Write all bytes. Returns count.
<code>file_seek(h, pos, whence)</code>	whence = <code>start</code> <code>cur</code> <code>end</code> . Returns new position.
<code>file_tell(h)</code>	Current position.
<code>file_flush(h)</code>	Sync buffered writes.
<code>file_close(h)</code>	Close (drops the underlying file).

Examples

```
// Whole-file
let data = file_read("config.json");
file_write_all("/tmp/copy.json", data);
file_append_all("/tmp/audit.log", `probe at ${now()}\n`);

// Check before read
if !file_exists("secrets.key") {
    eprint("missing key");
    return 2;
}

// Streaming – copy with 4KB chunks
let src = file_open("big.bin", "r");
let dst = file_open("/tmp/big.bin.copy", "w");
loop {
    let chunk = file_read(src, 4096);
    if chunk.len() == 0 { break; }
    file_write(dst, chunk);
}
file_close(src);
file_close(dst);

// Random access
let h = file_open("/tmp/log.bin", "rwc");
file_write(h, "record-1\n");
file_write(h, "record-2\n");
file_seek(h, 0, "start");
let head = file_read_all(h);
print(`contents: ${head.len()} bytes`);
file_close(h);
```

Comparison bindings

0.53.0. Diff two in-memory values (strings or Blobs).

Function	Returns	Description
<code>compare(a, b)</code>	Map	<code>{ identical, binary, a_bytes, b_bytes, added, removed, diff }</code> .

Both `a` and `b` accept strings OR Blobs. The binding does NOT fetch URLs — scripts should pre-load via `http()` or `file_read()` and pass the bytes.

Examples

```
// Compare two API responses
let a = http("https://api.v1.example.com/users/42").body;
let b = http("https://api.v2.example.com/users/42").body;
let r = compare(a, b);
if r.identical {
    print("parity OK");
    return 0;
}
print(`diverged: +${r.added} / -${r.removed}`);
print_raw(r.diff);
return 1;

// Compare a live URL against a baseline file
let live = http("https://example.com/status").body;
let baseline = file_read("status.baseline").to_string();
let r = compare(live.to_string(), baseline);
if !r.identical { print_raw(r.diff); }

// Binary content
let old = file_read("logo.v1.png");
let new = file_read("logo.v2.png");
let r = compare(old, new);
print(`binary: ${r.binary}, size delta: ${r.b_bytes - r.a_bytes}`);
```

HTTP binding

The workhorse. Two call forms:

```
http(url)           → response map
http(url, opts)     → response map
```

Response map

Key	Type	Description
status	int	HTTP status code.
url	string	Original URL.
final_url	string	After redirects.
headers	Map	Response headers; values are strings (first) or arrays when repeated.
body	Blob string	Response body. String when content-type is text-ish; Blob otherwise.
duration_ms	int	Total wall-clock time.
http_version	string	HTTP/1.1 , HTTP/2 , etc.

Options map

Every key is optional.

Key	Type	Description
method	string	GET, POST, PUT, PATCH, DELETE, HEAD.
headers	Map	Key → value (or array of values). Merged with CLI <code>-H</code> defaults.
body	string / Blob	Request body.
json	Dynamic	Serialize as JSON, set <code>Content-Type</code> + <code>Accept</code> .
form	Map	URL-encoded form body.
multipart	Array of Maps	Each Map has <code>name</code> , <code>value</code> or <code>file</code> , optional <code>filename</code> , <code>content_type</code> .
basic_auth	string	<code>"user:pass"</code> .
bearer	string	Bearer token.
user_agent	string	Override User-Agent.
referer	string	Referer.
timeout_ms	int	Total operation timeout.
connect_timeout	int	TCP connect timeout (seconds).
insecure	bool	Skip TLS verification.
follow_redirects	bool	Enable / disable redirect follow.

Key	Type	Description
max_redirects	int	Redirect cap.
compressed	bool	Request + auto-decompress.
cookiejar	string	Path to a SQLite cookie jar.
proxy	string	Proxy URL.
proxy_user	string	Proxy basic auth.
noproxy	string	Bypass list.
proxy_insecure	bool	Skip cert verification on proxy.
proxy_cacert	string	Extra CA for proxy.
unix_socket	string	Route via Unix socket.
hsts	string	Path to HSTS cache.
client_cert	string	PEM client cert.
client_key	string	PEM client key.
cert_type / key_type	string	PEM DER ENG (see CLI docs).
pass	string	PKCS#8 passphrase (reserved).

Examples

```

// Simple GET
let r = http("https://api.example.com/status");
print(`${r.status} ${r.body.len()} bytes`);

// POST JSON
let r = http("https://api.example.com/users", #{
  method: "POST",
  json: #{ name: "alice", email: "a@example.com" },
});
assert(r.status == 201, "create failed");

// Form POST
http("https://api.example.com/login", #{
  method: "POST",
  form: #{ user: "alice", pass: "s3cr3t" },
  cookiejar: "/tmp/jar.db",
});

// Multipart upload
http("https://upload.example.com/avatars", #{
  method: "POST",
  multipart: [
    #{ name: "title", value: "profile" },
    #{ name: "image", file: "avatar.png", content_type: "image/png" },
  ],
  bearer: env("API_TOKEN"),
});

// Bearer auth + timeout + compressed
let r = http("https://api.example.com/items", #{
  bearer: env("API_TOKEN"),
  timeout_ms: 5000,
  compressed: true,
  headers: #{ "Accept": "application/json" },
});

// Follow + retry on 5xx
for attempt in 0..3 {
  let r = http("https://api.example.com/", #{ follow_redirects: true });
  if r.status < 500 { return r.status == 200 ? 0 : 1; }
  sleep_ms(1000 * (attempt + 1));
}
return 2;

// Proxy + HSTS
http("http://example.com/", #{
  proxy: "socks5h://127.0.0.1:9050",
  hsts: "/tmp/hsts.txt",
});

```

```
});

// mTLS
http("https://mtls.example.com/", #{
  client_cert: "/etc/keys/bundle.pem",
});

// Unix socket
let r = http("http://localhost/v1.40/version", #{
  unix_socket: "/var/run/docker.sock",
});
print(json_stringify(json_parse(r.body), 2));
```

Browser (sticky-session) binding

A stateful HTTP "browser" — cookies and headers persist across calls against the same handle. Matches the common "log in once, then make authenticated requests" pattern.

Function	Description
<code>browser()</code>	New browser with a tempfile cookie jar.
<code>browser(opts)</code>	With initial config.
<code>use_persistent_session(name)</code>	Browser method; jar is <code>~/.recon/jars/<name>.db</code> .
<code>
.get(url [, opts])</code>	GET via the browser.
<code>
.post(url, opts)</code>	POST.
<code>
.put(url, opts) / .patch(...) / .delete(url [, opts])</code>	Other methods.
<code>
.request(method, url, opts)</code>	Catch-all.
<code>
.header(name, value)</code>	Sticky request header.
<code>
.headers(map)</code>	Merge sticky headers.
<code>
.clear_headers()</code>	Remove sticky headers.
<code>
.user_agent(str)</code>	Override User-Agent for the lifetime of the browser.
<code>
.basic_auth(user, pass)</code>	Sticky Basic auth.
<code>
.timeout_ms(n) / .connect_timeout(secs)</code>	Sticky timeouts.

Function	Description
<code>
.insecure(bool) / .follow_redirects(bool) / .max_redirects(n)</code>	Sticky knobs.
<code>
.cookiejar()</code>	Current jar path.
<code>
.cookies()</code>	Array of cookie records from the jar.
<code>
.cookie_set(name, value, domain, path)</code>	Inject a cookie.

Examples

```
// Login, then fetch protected resources
let br = browser();
br.user_agent("recon-test/0.58");
br.post("https://example.com/login", #{
  form: #{ user: "alice", pass: "s3cr3t" },
});
let r = br.get("https://example.com/dashboard");
assert(r.status == 200, "dashboard fetch failed");

// Persist across runs – next invocation sees the same cookies
let br = browser();
br.use_persistent_session("gh-session");
br.header("Accept", "application/vnd.github+json");
let r = br.get("https://api.github.com/user");

// Multi-persona fan-out
let personas = [{ name: "a", jar: "persona-a" }, { name: "b", jar: "persona-b" }];
for p in personas {
  let br = browser();
  br.use_persistent_session(p.jar);
  let r = br.get("https://api.example.com/whoami");
  print(`${p.name}: ${r.status}`);
}
```

TCP, TCP-server, UDP

0.57.0 shipped the server bindings. Handles are Send+Sync so they survive `thread_spawn` (0.56.0) boundaries — the expected pattern is "accept on main, spawn a handler per connection".

TCP client (existing)

Function	Description
<code>tcp(url)</code>	TCP connect probe; returns <code>#{ status, duration_ms, ...}</code> .
<code>tcp(url, opts)</code>	With <code>timeout</code> (ms).

TCP server (0.57.0)

Function	Description
<code>tcp_listen(addr)</code>	Bind. <code>addr</code> like <code>"0.0.0.0:8080"</code> or <code>"[::]:8080"</code> .
<code>tcp_accept(listener)</code>	Blocking accept. Returns a <code>TcpConn</code> .
<code>tcp_accept(listener, timeout_ms)</code>	Times out with an error.
<code>tcp_read(conn, n, timeout_ms)</code>	Read up to N bytes → <code>Blob</code> .
<code>tcp_read_line(conn, timeout_ms)</code>	<code>\n</code> -terminated line; CR/LF stripped.
<code>tcp_write(conn, blob str)</code>	Write all. Returns bytes.
<code>tcp_peer_addr(conn)</code>	Remote <code>SocketAddr</code> string.
<code>tcp_close(conn)</code>	Close connection.
<code>tcp_close_listener(l)</code>	Close listener.

UDP

Function	Description
<code>udp_bind(addr)</code>	Bind.
<code>udp_recv_from(sock, max_len)</code>	Block until a datagram arrives. Returns <code>#{ data: Blob, addr: string }</code> .
<code>udp_recv_from(sock, max_len, timeout_ms)</code>	With timeout.
<code>udp_send_to(sock, blob str, addr)</code>	Returns bytes sent.
<code>udp_close(sock)</code>	Release.

Examples

```
// TCP client probe
let r = tcp("example.com:443");
print(`${r.status} in ${r.duration_ms}ms`);

// Concurrent TCP echo server (from script/tcp-echo.rhai)
let l = tcp_listen("127.0.0.1:9000");
loop {
    let conn = tcp_accept(l);
    thread_spawn(|c| {
        let peer = tcp_peer_addr(c);
        let line = tcp_read_line(c, 5000);
        tcp_write(c, `echo: ${line}` + "\n");
        tcp_close(c);
    }, conn);
}

// UDP listener (from script/udp-listen.rhai)
let s = udp_bind("127.0.0.1:9001");
loop {
    let r = udp_recv_from(s, 65536, 30000);
    print(`${r.addr} → ${r.data.len()} bytes`);
}

// UDP beacon sender
let s = udp_bind("0.0.0.0:0");
for i in 0..5 {
    udp_send_to(s, `beacon-${i}`, "127.0.0.1:9001");
    sleep_ms(200);
}
udp_close(s);
```

Threading bindings

0.56.0. Requires rhai's `sync` feature (enabled). `spawn` alone is reserved by Rhai — use `thread_spawn`.

Function	Description
<code>thread_spawn(fn_ptr)</code>	Spawn a closure. Returns a <code>ThreadHandle</code> .
<code>thread_spawn(fn_ptr, arg)</code>	With one forwarded arg.
<code>thread_spawn(fn_ptr, args_array)</code>	With N args.
<code>join(h)</code>	Block; returns the closure's return value (or the worker's error).

Function	Description
<code>tid()</code>	Current thread id (stable within a run).
<code>sleep(ms)</code>	Alias of <code>sleep_ms</code> .
<code>channel()</code>	Unbounded MPSC — returns <code>[sender, receiver]</code> .
<code>channel_bounded(n)</code>	Bounded; <code>try_send</code> returns false when full.
<code>send(tx, val)</code>	Blocking send.
<code>try_send(tx, val)</code>	Non-blocking; false on full.
<code>recv(rx)</code>	Blocking.
<code>recv(rx, timeout_ms)</code>	With timeout.
<code>try_recv(rx)</code>	Non-blocking; <code>()</code> when empty.

Examples

```

// Fan out probes, gather via channel
let c = channel();
let tx = c[0];
let rx = c[1];

let urls = [
    "https://a.example.com/",
    "https://b.example.com/",
    "https://c.example.com/",
];

for url in urls {
    thread_spawn(|u| {
        let r = http(u, #{ timeout_ms: 5000 });
        send(tx, `${u} → ${r.status}`);
    }, url);
}

for i in 0..urls.len() {
    print(recv(rx, 10000));
}

// Bounded channel – producer/consumer with back-pressure
let c = channel_bounded(4);
let tx = c[0];
let rx = c[1];

thread_spawn(|| {
    for i in 0..100 { send(tx, i); }
});

let sum = 0;
for j in 0..100 {
    sum += recv(rx, 1000);
}
print(`total: ${sum}`);

// Join for return value
let h = thread_spawn(|| {
    // Do something heavy
    let r = http("https://slow.example.com/");
    r.status
});
let status = join(h);
print(`completed with status ${status}`);

```

DNS binding

Function	Description
<code>dns(host)</code>	Default bundle: A, AAAA, MX, TXT, NS, CNAME, SOA. Returns a Map keyed by record type.
<code>dns(host, types_str)</code>	Custom types: "A,AAAA,MX" .
<code>dns(host, types_str, opts)</code>	<code>opts</code> may contain <code>servers: "1.1.1.1,8.8.8.8"</code> .

Examples

```
let r = dns("example.com");
print(`A: ${r.A.join(", ")}`);
print(`MX: ${r.MX.join(", ")}`);

// Custom resolver
let r = dns("example.com", "A,AAAA", #{ servers: "127.0.0.1:5353" });
print(r);

// Check DNSSEC chain presence
let r = dns("example.com", "DNSKEY,DS");
if r.DNSKEY.len() == 0 { print("no DNSKEY"); }
```

TLS probe binding

Function	Description
<code>tls(host [, opts])</code>	Handshake + cert introspection. Returns a Map with <code>subject</code> , <code>issuer</code> , <code>sans</code> , <code>not_before</code> , <code>not_after</code> , <code>days_remaining</code> , <code>fingerprints</code> , <code>chain</code> , <code>tls_version</code> , <code>cipher_suite</code> .

Examples

```

let t = tls("example.com:443");
print(`CN: ${t.subject}`);
print(`issuer: ${t.issuer}`);
print(`expires in ${t.days_remaining} days`);
if t.days_remaining < 14 { eprint("cert expiring soon"); return 1; }

// Verify an expected subject
let t = tls("api.example.com:443");
assert(t.sans.contains("api.example.com"), "SAN mismatch");

// Per-host SNI override
let t = tls("alt.example.com:443", #{ sni: "primary.example.com" });

```

Ping binding

Function	Description
<code>ping(host)</code>	Default TCP ping, 4 packets. Returns <code>#{ sent, received, loss_pct, min_ms, avg_ms, max_ms, ...}</code> .
<code>ping(host, opts)</code>	<code>opts</code> supports <code>count</code> , <code>icmp: true</code> , <code>timeout_ms</code> .

Examples

```

let r = ping("8.8.8.8");
print(`${r.received}/${r.sent} received, avg ${r.avg_ms}ms`);

// ICMP (needs privileges on macOS/Linux for non-DGRAM types)
let r = ping("example.com", #{ icmp: true, count: 10 });

// TCP ping to a specific port
let r = ping("example.com:443");
assert(r.received > 0, "no reachability");

```

File transfer bindings

FTP

Function	Description
<code>ftp(url)</code>	FTP / FTPS anonymous listing or retrieve.
<code>ftp(url, opts)</code>	<code>opts</code> : <code>user</code> , <code>pass</code> , <code>ftps_implicit</code> .

SFTP

Function	Description
<code>sftp(url)</code>	SSH-backed listing or retrieve.
<code>sftp(url, opts)</code>	<code>opts</code> : <code>user</code> , <code>pass</code> , <code>privkey</code> , <code>port</code> .

TFTP

Function	Description
<code>tftp(url)</code>	RFC 1350 download.
<code>tftp(url, opts)</code>	<code>opts</code> : <code>blksize</code> (RFC 2348).

Gopher

Function	Description
<code>gopher(url)</code>	RFC 1436 selector fetch.

Examples

```
let listing = ftp("ftp://ftp.example.com/");
print(`${listing.entries.len()} entries`);

let data = ftp("ftp://ftp.example.com/file.bin");
print(`${data.size} bytes`);

let h = sftp("sftp://me@example.com/srv/app.log", #{ privkey: "~/.ssh/ci_rsa"
file_write_all("/tmp/app.log", h.body);

let img = tftp("tftp://tftp.example.com/boot.img", #{ blksize: 8192 });
print(img.size);

let g = gopher("gopher://gopher.floodgap.com/0/gopher/proxy");
print_raw(g.body);
```

Mail retrieval bindings

POP3

Function	Description
<code>pop3(url)</code>	Capability + message listing.

Function	Description
<code>pop3(url, opts)</code>	<code>opts: stls</code> , <code>retrieve_index</code> (int, 1-based).

IMAP

Function	Description
<code>imap(url)</code>	EXAMINE + capabilities.
<code>imap(url, opts)</code>	<code>opts: fetch</code> (int — message index), <code>peek: true</code> .

Examples

```
// POP3 probe with STLS
let r = pop3("pop3://alice:s3cr3t@pop.example.com/", #{ stls: true });
print(`${r.message_count} messages`);

let first = pop3("pop3s://alice:s3cr3t@pop.example.com/", #{ retrieve_index:
print_raw(first.body);

// IMAP peek
let r = imap("imaps://alice:s3cr3t@imap.example.com/INBOX", #{ fetch: 3, peek
print_raw(r.body);
```

SMTP binding

Function	Description
<code>smtp(url)</code>	Capability + STARTTLS probe.
<code>smtp(url, opts)</code>	Send a message. <code>opts</code> keys: <code>from</code> , <code>to</code> (array), <code>subject</code> , <code>body</code> , <code>headers</code> , <code>auth</code> ("user:pass"), <code>helo</code> , <code>no_starttls</code> , <code>dkim_key</code> , <code>dkim_selector</code> , <code>dkim_domain</code> .

Examples

```
// Probe only
let r = smtp("smtp://mail.example.com:25");
print(`capabilities: ${r.capabilities.join(", ")}`);

// Send
smtp("smtp://smtp.example.com:587", #{
  from: "me@example.com",
  to: ["you@example.com"],
  subject: "Automated notice",
  body: "Probe result: OK",
  auth: env("SMTP_CREDS"),
});

// DKIM-signed
smtp("smtp://smtp.example.com:587", #{
  from: "me@example.com",
  to: ["you@example.com"],
  subject: "Signed",
  body: "This message is DKIM-signed.",
  dkim_key: "~/dkim/default.pem",
  dkim_selector: "default",
});
```

WebSocket binding

Function	Description
<code>ws(url)</code>	Handshake + Ping/Pong. Returns <code>#{ status, duration_ms, negotiated_protocol }</code> .
<code>ws(url, opts)</code>	<code>opts: headers, subprotocols, send_text, send_binary.</code>

Examples

```
let r = ws("wss://echo.websocket.events");
print(`connected in ${r.duration_ms}ms`);

// Send a frame, check response
let r = ws("wss://echo.websocket.events", #{ send_text: "hello" });
print(r.received);
```

Other protocol bindings

Brief interface reference; each has at least one example in `script/*.rhai`.

LDAP

```
let r = ldap("ldap://ldap.example.com");           // anonymous RootDSE query
```

RTSP

```
let r = rtsp("rtsp://camera.example.com/stream1");
```

Dict

```
let r = dict("dict://dict.org/d:recon");
```

NTP

```
let r = ntp("ntp://pool.ntp.org");  
print(`offset: ${r.offset_ms}ms, rtt: ${r.rtt_ms}ms`);
```

Memcached

```
let r = memcached("memcache://cache.example.com/?version");  
let s = memcached("memcache://cache.example.com/", #{ command: "stats" });
```

Redis

```
let r = redis("redis://cache.example.com/");       // PING  
let info = redis("redis://cache.example.com/", #{ command: "INFO server" });
```

MQTT

```
let r = mqtt("mqtt://broker.example.com", #{  
    topic: "sensors/room-1",  
    message: '{"temp": 21.3}',  
});
```

Encoding & decoding bindings

0.55.0 expanded encode with Aztec + PDF417 and added decode.

Function	Description
<code>encode::qr(text)</code>	PNG Blob.
<code>encode::datamatrix(text)</code>	PNG Blob.
<code>encode::barcode(format, text)</code>	PNG Blob for any 1D/2D.
<code>encode::encode(format, text)</code>	PNG Blob (default renderer).
<code>encode::encode(format, text, output_format)</code>	<code>output_format = ascii / svg / png</code> . Returns string for ascii/svg, Blob for png.
<code>encode::encode(format, text, output_format, opts)</code>	<code>opts: qr_level: "L" "M" "Q" "H"</code> .
<code>encode::decode(blob)</code>	Scan an image Blob → <code>{ text, format }</code> .
<code>encode::list()</code>	Supported format names.

Examples

```
// Generate QR
let png = encode::qr("https://example.com");
file_write_all("/tmp/site.png", png);

// Tune QR durability
let png = encode::encode("qr", "sticker-text", "png", #{ qr_level: "H" });

// Get SVG
let svg = encode::encode("qr", "recon", "svg");
file_write_all("/tmp/site.svg", svg);

// Decode
let data = file_read("/tmp/site.png");
let r = encode::decode(data);
print(`${r.format}: ${r.text}`);

// Round-trip test
let png = encode::qr("hello");
let r = encode::decode(png);
assert(r.text == "hello", "round-trip failed");
```

Hashing binding

Ten algorithms plus CRC32.

Function	Description
<code>md5(data)</code>	MD5 (hex string).
<code>sha1(data)</code>	SHA-1.
<code>sha224 / sha256 / sha384 / sha512</code>	SHA-2 family.
<code>sha3_256 / sha3_512</code>	SHA-3.
<code>blake3(data)</code>	BLAKE3.
<code>crc32(data)</code>	CRC32 (hex, 8 chars).
<code>hmac_sha256(key, data)</code>	Keyed HMAC.

`data` accepts string or Blob.

Examples

```
let h = sha256(file_read("big.iso"));
print(h);

// HMAC
let sig = hmac_sha256("sharedsecret", "payload");
print(sig);

// Hash an HTTP body
let r = http("https://example.com/");
let fp = blake3(r.body);
print(`fingerprint: ${fp}`);
```

Compression & archive bindings

Compression

Function	Description
<code>compression::compress(algo, data [, level])</code>	<code>algo</code> = <code>gzip</code> , <code>deflate</code> , <code>brotli</code> , <code>zstd</code> , <code>bzip2</code> , <code>lz4</code> , <code>xz</code> , <code>snap</code> .
<code>compression::decompress(algo, data)</code>	Reverse.
<code>compression::decompress_auto(data)</code>	Auto-detect from magic bytes.
<code>compression::list()</code>	Supported algos.

Archive

Function	Description
<code>archive::create(dest_path, sources_array)</code>	Infer format from extension.
<code>archive::extract(src_path, dest_dir)</code>	Extract zip/tar/tar.gz/tar.xz/tar.bz2.

Examples

```
// Round-trip
let body = http("https://example.com/page.html").body;
let gz = compression::compress("gzip", body, 6);
print(`${body.len()} → ${gz.len()} bytes`);
let back = compression::decompress("gzip", gz);
assert(back.len() == body.len(), "round-trip");

// Zip up
archive::create("/tmp/backup.zip", ["file1.txt", "dir1/"]);
archive::extract("/tmp/backup.zip", "/tmp/restore/");
```

Encryption bindings

age + PGP shell-out.

Function	Description
<code>encrypt::keygen()</code>	New X25519 age keypair. Returns <code>#{ public, private }</code> .
<code>encrypt::encrypt(data, recipients)</code>	<code>recipients</code> = array of age-pub strings.
<code>encrypt::decrypt(data, identity)</code>	<code>identity</code> = secret key string.
<code>encrypt::encrypt_passphrase(data, passphrase)</code>	Script-based.
<code>encrypt::decrypt_passphrase(data, passphrase)</code>	—

Examples

```

let kp = encrypt::keygen();
print(`public: ${kp.public}`);
file_write_all("~/age/identity", kp.private);

let plaintext = "highly classified";
let ct = encrypt::encrypt(plaintext, [kp.public]);
let pt = encrypt::decrypt(ct, kp.private);
assert(pt.to_string() == plaintext, "round-trip");

let ct2 = encrypt::encrypt_passphrase("hello", "correct horse battery staple")

```

Check-digit binding

Function	Description
<code>checkdigit::verify(algo, input)</code>	true / false.
<code>checkdigit::create(algo, partial)</code>	Computed full value.
<code>checkdigit::list()</code>	All 60+ algorithm names.

Examples

```

assert(checkdigit::verify("isbn13", "9780131103627"), "valid ISBN");

let full = checkdigit::create("ean13", "400638133393");
print(full);           // 4006381333931

for algo in checkdigit::list() {
    print(algo);
}

```

Sample-data binding

Function	Description
<code>sample::get(name)</code>	String content of a named sample.
<code>sample::list()</code>	Array of sample names.

Examples

```
let u = sample::get("json-user");
print(u);

for s in sample::list() { print(s); }
```

JWT binding

Function	Description
<code>jwt::view(token)</code>	Decode header + claims (no signature check).
<code>jwt::sign(payload_map, opts)</code>	opts: alg, secret or key path.
<code>jwt::validate(token, opts)</code>	opts: alg, secret or key / pubkey.

Examples

```
let t = jwt::sign({ sub: "alice", exp: now() + 3600 }, {
  alg: "HS256",
  secret: env("JWT_SECRET"),
});

let ok = jwt::validate(t, { alg: "HS256", secret: env("JWT_SECRET") });
assert(ok, "validation failed");

let parts = jwt::view(t);
print(`alg: ${parts.header.alg}, sub: ${parts.payload.sub}`);
```

Email-protection binding

Function	Description
<code>email::spf(domain)</code>	SPF record + validation.
<code>email::dmarc(domain)</code>	DMARC policy.
<code>email::dkim(domain, selector)</code>	DKIM record for selector.
<code>email::mta_sts(domain)</code>	MTA-STS policy.
<code>email::bimi(domain [, selector])</code>	BIMI record.
<code>email::tls_rpt(domain)</code>	SMTP TLS-RPT record.

Examples

```

let s = email::spf("example.com");
if s.valid { print("SPF OK"); } else { print(`SPF: ${s.error}`); }

let d = email::dmarc("example.com");
print(`policy: ${d.policy}`);

let dk = email::dkim("example.com", "selector1");
print(dk.record);

```

Netstatus binding

Function	Description
<code>netstatus::run()</code>	Execute the probe bundle defined in <code>~/.recon/config.toml</code> [netstatus] .

```

let r = netstatus::run();
for p in r.probes {
    print(`${p.name}: ${p.status}`);
}

```

Text-encoding binding

Function	Description
<code>text::decode(blob, charset)</code>	Decode bytes → string.
<code>text::encode(string, charset)</code>	Encode string → bytes.
<code>text::detect(blob)</code>	Auto-detect (<code>chardetng</code>). Returns charset label.
<code>text::normalize_newlines(s, style)</code>	style = <code>unix</code> / <code>windows</code> / <code>mac</code> .
<code>text::list_charsets()</code>	Supported labels.

Examples

```

let bytes = file_read("greek.txt");
let charset = text::detect(bytes);
let utf8 = text::decode(bytes, charset);
file_write_all("greek-utf8.txt", text::encode(utf8, "utf-8"));

let crlf = text::normalize_newlines("line1\nline2\n", "windows");

```

Whois binding

Function	Description
<code>whois(domain)</code>	Two-hop whois (registry then registrar). Returns raw text.

```
let w = whois("example.com");
print_raw(w);
```

IPFS binding

Function	Description
<code>ipfs(url)</code>	Fetch <code>ipfs://</code> or <code>ipns://</code> via the configured gateway.

```
let data = ipfs("ipfs://QmYwAPJzv5CZsnA625s3Xf2nemtYgPpHdWEz79ojWnPbdG");
print(data.body.len());
```

Agent-browser binding

Exposed as a static module. Requires `agent-browser` on `$PATH`.

Function	Description
<code>agentBrowser::available</code>	Bool.
<code>agentBrowser::version</code>	Version string.
<code>agentBrowser::open(url)</code>	Navigate to URL.
<code>agentBrowser::close()</code>	End the session.
<code>agentBrowser::click(selector)</code>	Click by CSS selector or <code>@ref</code> .
<code>agentBrowser::fill(selector, text)</code>	Fill a form field.
<code>agentBrowser::type(selector, text)</code>	Type into a field (character events).
<code>agentBrowser::keyboard_type(text)</code>	Keyboard-level typing.
<code>agentBrowser::press(key)</code>	Key press (e.g. "Enter", "Tab").
<code>agentBrowser::screenshot(path)</code>	Save PNG.
<code>agentBrowser::pdf(path)</code>	Save PDF.
<code>agentBrowser::snapshot()</code>	Accessibility-tree dump.
<code>agentBrowser::eval(js)</code>	Execute JS, return the value.

Function	Description
<code>agentBrowser::get(selector)</code>	Read innerText / value.
<code>agentBrowser::find(selector)</code>	Locate (returns ref).
<code>agentBrowser::cmd(args_array)</code>	Raw passthrough to the CLI.

Examples

```
if !agentBrowser::available { return 2; }

agentBrowser::open("https://example.com/login");
agentBrowser::fill("#user", "alice");
agentBrowser::fill("#pass", "s3cr3t");
agentBrowser::click("button[type=submit]");
agentBrowser::screenshot("/tmp/after-login.png");
agentBrowser::close();
```

SQLite binding

Function	Description
<code>sqlite(spec) / sqlite(spec, mode)</code>	Open. spec = path, <code>":memory:"</code> , or an alias. mode = <code>ro</code> <code>rw</code> (default) <code>rwc</code> .
<code>.query(sql) / .query(sql, params)</code>	Array of Maps.
<code>.query_one(sql, params)</code>	First row as a Map (or <code>()</code>).
<code>.query_value(sql, params)</code>	Single scalar value.
<code>.exec(sql, params)</code>	Row count affected.

Examples

```
let db = sqlite(":memory:");
db.exec("CREATE TABLE users (id INTEGER PRIMARY KEY, name TEXT);");
db.exec("INSERT INTO users (name) VALUES (?)", ["alice"]);
db.exec("INSERT INTO users (name) VALUES (?)", ["bob"]);

let rows = db.query("SELECT id, name FROM users ORDER BY id");
for r in rows {
  print(`${r.id}: ${r.name}`);
}

let count = db.query_value("SELECT COUNT(*) FROM users");
print(`total: ${count}`);
```

Document-conversion bindings

0.58.0. comrak for HTML; agent-browser for PDF.

Function	Description
<code>md_to_html(md)</code> / <code>md_to_html(md, opts)</code>	Markdown (string or Blob) → HTML string.
<code>md_to_pdf(md, dest)</code> / <code>md_to_pdf(md, dest, opts)</code>	Markdown → PDF at <code>dest</code> . Needs agent-browser.
<code>html_to_pdf(html, dest)</code>	HTML → PDF at <code>dest</code> . Needs agent-browser.

Opts map

Key	Default	Description
<code>toc</code>	false	Inject linkable TOC.
<code>toc_depth</code>	3	Include H1..H N.
<code>toc_title</code>	"Contents"	—
<code>title</code>	document default	<code><title></code> + PDF metadata.
<code>css</code>	—	Additional CSS (appended after default).
<code>no_default_css</code>	false	Skip bundled default CSS.
<code>gfm</code>	false	GitHub-flavored extensions.

Examples

```
let md = file_read("README.md").to_string();

// md → html
let html = md_to_html(md, #{ toc: true, toc_depth: 3, gfm: true, title: "README" });
file_write_all("/tmp/readme.html", html);

// md → pdf
md_to_pdf(md, "/tmp/readme.pdf", #{ toc: true, gfm: true, title: "README" });

// html → pdf
let html = http("https://example.com/report.html").body.to_string();
html_to_pdf(html, "/tmp/report.pdf");

// Fully custom styling
md_to_pdf(md, "/tmp/styled.pdf", #{
  no_default_css: true,
  css: file_read("print.css").to_string(),
  toc: true,
  toc_title: "Table of Contents",
});
```

Part IV — Appendices

Exit codes

Curl-compatible exit codes for common cases:

Code	Meaning
0	Success.
1	Generic protocol error.
2	Source-load error (<code>--compare</code> , etc.).
3	Agent-browser / Chrome unavailable (PDF features).
6	DNS resolution failed.
7	Connection refused.
22	HTTP ≥ 400 with <code>-f</code> (or <code>--fail-with-body</code>).
28	Operation timeout (<code>--max-time</code>).
35	TLS handshake error.
47	Redirect limit exceeded.
52	Empty reply from server.
55	Send error.
56	Receive error.
60	Peer cert cannot be authenticated.

Script-mode exit codes:

- `return N` from the top-level script becomes the process exit code (mod 256).
- Unhandled script errors → exit 1 (or the last `ProtocolExitCode` tag).

Environment variables

Variable	Read by	Description
<code>HTTP_PROXY</code> / <code>http_proxy</code>	<code>--proxy</code>	Proxy for http:// URLs.

Variable	Read by	Description
HTTPS_PROXY / https_proxy	--proxy	Proxy for https:// URLs.
ALL_PROXY / all_proxy	--proxy	Fallback proxy.
NO_PROXY / no_proxy	--noproxy	Bypass list.
SSL_CERT_FILE	--cacert	Extra trust-root bundle.
CURL_CA_BUNDLE	--cacert	Same as SSL_CERT_FILE.
RECON_NO_PAGER	--help / --examples	Disable paging.
RECON_IPFS_GATEWAY	--ipfs-gateway	Default IPFS gateway.
RECON_CONFIG	config file	Override path to config.toml .
AGENT_BROWSER_JSON	—	When 1 , agent-browser returns JSON (set internally by recon).
EDITOR	--editor	Editor binary for response inspection.
HOME	various	Used to locate ~/.recon/ .
PAGER	--help / --examples	Override default less -FRX .

Configuration file

~/.recon/config.toml — commented skeleton created by recon --init .

Structure

```
# Default flag overrides
[defaults]
connect_timeout = 30
max_time = 60
user_agent = "recon/0.58.1 (auto)"

# Netstatus probe bundle
[netstatus]
probes = [
    { name = "dns", target = "8.8.8.8" },
    { name = "http", url = "https://example.com/" },
    { name = "tls", target = "example.com:443" },
]

# Per-host SNI → cert mapping for --serve-tls
[[serve_sni]]
host = "a.example.com"
cert = "/etc/certs/a.pem"
key = "/etc/certs/a.key"

[[serve_sni]]
host = "b.example.com"
cert = "/etc/certs/b.pem"
key = "/etc/certs/b.key"
```

~/.recon/ layout

Created by `recon --init`:

```
~/.recon/
├── config.toml           # Commented skeleton; overrideable via RECON_CONF
├── script/              # Bare-word scripts (`recon --script NAME`)
│   └── *.rhai
├── jars/                # Persistent cookie jars
│   └── <session>.db
├── sni/                 # Per-host TLS cert + key pairs for --serve-tls
│   ├── a.example.com/cert.pem
│   └── a.example.com/key.pem
└── hsts.txt              # Optional HSTS cache (curl-compatible)
```

Glossary

- **Sticky session** — a `browser()` handle whose cookies + headers persist across calls. Pair with `use_persistent_session` for cross-invocation persistence.

- **Script defaults** — the frozen snapshot of CLI flags (`-H`, `-k`, `--connect-timeout`, ...) that every script binding inherits when the caller doesn't override via an opts map.
 - **Bare-word script** — one that can be invoked by name because it lives in `~/.recon/script/`, e.g. `recon --script http` → `~/.recon/script/http.rhai`.
 - **Protocol exit code** — recon's internal scheme for passing an exit code through a panic-style error path from protocol bindings (so a failed SMTP probe can exit with curl's `CURLE_URL_MALFORMAT`, for instance).
 - **agent-browser** — external CLI that wraps Chrome DevTools Protocol. Used for `--browser-screenshot`, `--md-to-pdf`, `--html-to-pdf`, and the `agentBrowser::*` script bindings.
-

End of manual. For the curated-example companion, run `recon --examples`. For topic-specific deep dives, run `recon --help <topic>`.